

Column mapping: auto-suggested and manual

KQ Bank Reconciliation System · For preparers and reviewers · Updated September 2026

This guide explains the full **Map** step: how the system reads your uploaded files, how **auto-suggested mapping** works, when you must map **manually**, and how to confirm you are ready for Reconcile and Report. Mapping is a one-time setup per document; matching happens later on the Reconcile tab.

1. Where mapping fits in the workflow

Step	Tab	What you do
1. Upload	Upload	Add cash book and bank statement files. Choose Receipts, Payments, Both, or bank Credits/Debits as needed.
2. Map	Map	This guide. Tell the system which column is Date, Amount, Description, etc. Extract transactions.
3. Reconcile	Reconcile	Link cash book rows to bank rows (or leave unmatched for BRS timing items).
4. Review / Report	Report	Check variance, enter closing balances, export the Bank Reconciliation Statement (BRS).

2. Key concepts before you map

2.1 Mapping vs matching

Mapping connects your file’s columns to standard fields (Date, Amount received, Credit, etc.). It runs once per logical document and produces the transaction list used everywhere else. **Matching** (Reconcile) links an extracted cash book row to a bank row. Do not confuse the two.

2.2 Logical document types

One physical Excel file may become several logical documents in the project:

- **cash_book_receipts** — money recorded as received (map Amount received).
- **cash_book_payments** — money recorded as paid (map Amount paid).
- **bank_credits** — credits on the bank statement.
- **bank_debits** — debits on the bank statement.

If you uploaded a cash book as **Both**, you will map the same file twice — once for receipts and once for payments — usually with the same worksheet but different amount columns.

3. What happens when you map (behind the scenes)

- The file is read (Excel, CSV, PDF, or scanned image).
- For Excel workbooks with multiple tabs, a **worksheet** is chosen (see Section 5).
- Header rows are detected. Supported Ghana banks and ERP layouts may be normalised automatically.
- Each canonical field (Date, Amount, ...) is linked to a column index.
- Rows are extracted: dates parsed (including Excel serial dates), amounts cleaned, zero lines skipped.
- Duplicate identical rows may be skipped (same date, amount, and narrative).
- Transactions are stored for Reconcile and Report.

Required: Every document must have a **date** column mapped. Without a date, matching and ageing cannot run reliably.

4. Auto-suggested mapping (bulk apply)

On the Map tab, the panel **Bulk apply — which files?** lists every uploaded document. Ticked files are included when you click **Apply suggested mapping to selected**. New uploads are ticked automatically; untick any file you want to skip or map by hand.

4.1 What the system suggests

- Matches header names to standard fields (Date, Credit, Debit, Description, Cheque no., etc.).
- For Excel, picks the **best worksheet** — the tab with date + amount columns and the most transaction rows.
- Applies a **saved layout** from your organisation if a similar file was mapped before.
- For known Ghana bank exports (Ecobank, GCB, SCB, NIB, BOG, Absa, Stanbic, ...), may apply bank-specific normalisation.
- For TGL/IBIS ERP cash books, may split signed Amount into receipt and payment columns and preserve foreign-currency columns.

4.2 When auto-suggested is enough

Situation	Recommendation
Single-sheet cash book or bank statement	Use bulk apply, then spot-check row counts.
Monthly export with clear Date + Debit/Credit columns	Use bulk apply.
Same layout as a file you mapped last month (saved layout banner)	Use bulk apply; adjust only if preview looks wrong.
Report tie-out variance ≈ 0 after mapping	Proceed to Reconcile.

4.3 After bulk apply — read the summary

Message	Meaning
X transaction(s) extracted	Mapping succeeded for that file.
Sign warnings	Some amounts have unexpected signs (e.g. negative in a receipts column). Review preview.
Skipped duplicate rows	Identical lines were deduplicated.
Skipped zero-amount rows	Blank or zero lines ignored.
Some files have no extracted transactions	That document still needs mapping or the sheet has no data.

5. Manual mapping (individual documents)

Use **Or select a document to map or adjust** when bulk apply is wrong or you need to verify a multi-sheet workbook.

- Choose the document from the dropdown (e.g. acct430 cash book.xlsx — cash_book_receipts).
- Review the preview table (first rows and column indices).
- If the file has multiple tabs, open **Worksheet (Excel)** and pick the correct sheet.
- For each canonical field, select the matching source column.
- Read Fix required / Check / Tip messages and confidence labels (high / medium / low).
- Click **Apply mapping**.

5.1 When you must map manually (or adjust after bulk apply)

Situation	What to do
Multi-sheet ERP export (TGL/IBIS) with notes tabs	Open cash book manually; select the pre-reconciliation sheet (not the double-entry sheet).
Auto-pick chose the tab with more rows but wrong data	Change Worksheet, clear mapping, re-apply.

Situation	What to do
Multi-currency — BRS uses foreign currency (EUR/USD)	Map FC AMT RECEIVED / FC AMT PAID (or Foreign Currency Amount), not GHS equivalent only.
Receipt/payment counts look inverted (e.g. 17 payments / 9 receipts when you expect the opposite)	Wrong worksheet or wrong amount column — re-map manually.
Yellow tie-out warning on Report after mapping	Re-check worksheet, closing balances, and do not accept wrong reconcile matches.
Saved layout applied but columns shifted	Adjust fields; use Forget layout if the saved map is wrong for this file type.

6. Worksheet (Excel) selection

When an Excel workbook has more than one tab, the Map page shows a **Worksheet (Excel)** dropdown. Bulk apply automatically uses the best transaction sheet (date + amount columns, row count, clean rows). You can change the tab at any time before Apply mapping; changing the sheet clears the current column picks.

Example — TGL GT Bank EUR (acct 430): Sheet1 contains double-entry and post-BRS updates; Sheet2 is the pre-reconciliation cash book. Auto-pick may choose Sheet1 because it has more rows. For BRS you must select **Sheet2** manually.

Alternative: Export only the correct sheet from your accounting system and upload that single-tab file — then auto-pick cannot choose the wrong tab.

7. Fields to map

7.1 Cash book

Field	App label	Required?	Notes
date	Date	Yes	Excel serial dates (e.g. 43388) convert automatically.
amt_received	Amount received	Receipts doc	Map for cash_book_receipts.
amt_paid	Amount paid	Payments doc	Map for cash_book_payments.
name / details	Name / Details	Optional	Improves matching and BRS narrative.
chq_no	Cheque no.	Optional	Strongly recommended for cheque matching.
doc_ref / accode	Doc ref / Account code	Optional	Reference and chart-of-accounts code.

7.2 Bank statement

Field	App label	Required?	Notes
transaction_date	Transaction date	Yes	
credit	Credit	Credits doc	Map for bank_credits.
debit	Debit	Debits doc	Map for bank_debits.
description	Description	Recommended	Cheque numbers can be read from narrative text.

7.3 Signed amount mode (one amount column)

If one column holds both sides (positive = receipt/credit, negative = payment/debit), map the **same column** to both amount fields. The app shows a Signed amount mode notice and splits rows by sign.

8. Saved layouts and Forget layout

After you apply a mapping, your organisation can **remember** that column layout (by header names). The next similar upload shows a **Saved layout applied** banner and pre-fills fields.

- **Forget layout** deletes that saved memory for future uploads. It does **not** unmap the current file or delete transactions.
- Map again and apply to save a new layout.
- Use Forget layout when the remembered columns are wrong for this export type going forward.

9. Decision guide — auto or manual?

Your file	Start with	Then
Bank statement (one sheet)	Bulk apply	Proceed if row count looks right.
Cash book (one sheet, clear headers)	Bulk apply	Proceed if row count looks right.
Multi-sheet ERP / TGL / IBIS export	Bulk apply	Open each cash book doc; confirm Worksheet; re-apply if needed.
GT Bank EUR + manual BRS target	Bulk apply + manual check	Sheet2, FC amounts, closing balances on Report, no spurious Reconcile matches.
Scanned PDF / poor OCR quality	Manual review	Prefer Excel export; verify every column in preview.

10. Checklist before Proceed to Reconcile

- Every uploaded document shows a transaction count (not zero).
- Cash book receipts + payments row counts match your source extract.

- Bank credits + debits match the statement.
- Correct Excel worksheet selected for multi-tab files.
- No Fix required messages on critical fields (Date, Amount).
- On Report (optional early check): enter bank and cash book closing balances if your BRS uses declared figures.
- Tie-out variance on Report is ≈ 0 (or you understand remaining exceptions).

11. Quick reference

Action	Where	Button / control
Map all ticked files at once	Map tab	Apply suggested mapping to selected
Map or fix one file	Map tab	Select a document → Apply mapping
Change Excel tab	Map tab → document open	Worksheet (Excel) dropdown
Remove saved column memory	Map tab → preview banner	Forget layout
Continue workflow	Map tab	Proceed to Reconcile

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